11–18 第二篇

The History of Writing: From Symbols to Stories

Long before books and computers, people found ways to record their thoughts and share information. The earliest forms of writing appeared about 5,000 years ago in places like Mesopotamia and Egypt. At first, people used simple pictures or symbols to represent objects and ideas. Over time, these symbols developed into full writing systems with hundreds or thousands of characters. Writing allowed cultures to keep records, pass down laws, and tell stories across generations. [1] The invention of writing was one of the most important breakthroughs in human history, as it allowed knowledge to be stored and shared in ways that speaking alone could never achieve.

Different cultures created different writing systems. The ancient Egyptians used hieroglyphics—picture-like symbols carved on stone. The Chinese developed characters that often combine meaning and sound. The Phoenicians created an alphabet that was easier to learn, and this idea spread to the Greeks and Romans. Each system shaped how people thought and communicated. [2] Despite their differences, all writing systems serve the same purpose: to turn spoken language into something that can be seen, saved, and read by others across time and space.

The materials used for writing have changed greatly over the centuries. Early writers used clay tablets, bamboo strips, or animal skins. Papyrus, made from a plant, became popular in ancient Egypt. Paper was invented in China around 2,000 years ago and later spread to other parts of the world. Today, most writing happens on screens. [3] Each new material made writing cheaper, easier, and more available to more people, helping spread literacy and ideas around the globe.

Writing has always been closely linked to power and education. In many ancient societies, only a small group of priests or scribes could read and write. As writing became simpler and materials cheaper, more people gained access to knowledge. The printing press, invented in the 1400s, allowed books to be copied quickly and cheaply. [4] The spread of writing and reading has gradually opened doors for more people to learn, think independently, and participate in society.

Today, we write in countless ways—text messages, emails, social media posts, and more. The tools have changed, but the human need to record, share, and remember has not. Writing remains at the heart of education, science, art, and daily communication. [5] From clay tablets to digital screens, writing continues to connect people and preserve the ideas that shape our world.

选项

A. The invention of writing was one of the most important breakthroughs in human history, as it allowed knowledge to be stored and shared in ways that speaking alone could never achieve. B. Despite their differences, all writing systems serve the same purpose: to turn spoken language into something that can be seen, saved, and read by others across time and space. C. Each new material made writing cheaper, easier, and more available to more people, helping spread literacy and ideas around the globe. D. The spread of writing and reading has gradually opened doors for more people to learn, think independently, and participate in society. E. From clay tablets to digital screens, writing continues to connect people and preserve the ideas that shape our world. F. For instance, the Rosetta Stone helped scholars decode Egyptian hieroglyphics because it contained the same text in three different scripts.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前介绍文字起源——约5000年前、图画符号、发展成完整书写系统、记录法律故事，空后需总结发明的历史意义。A的"one of the most important breakthroughs"与前文记录、传承功能呼应，"stored and shared in ways that speaking alone could never achieve"点明文字相对口传的独特价值。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前列举不同书写系统——象形文字、汉字、字母等，空后需提炼共同功能。B的"Despite their differences"承接前文多样书写系统，"serve the same purpose: to turn spoken language into something that can be seen, saved, and read"概括文字的本质作用。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：空前描述书写载体的演变——泥板、竹简、兽皮、纸莎草、纸张、屏幕，空后需总结材料进步的影响。C的"Each new material made writing cheaper, easier, and more available"与前文载体演化对应，"helping spread literacy and ideas"点明对普及读写与传播思想的作用。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：空前说明书写与权力、教育的关系——最初少数人掌握、后来更多人获得知识、印刷术推动传播，空后需总结读写普及的社会影响。D的"The spread of writing and reading has gradually opened doors"与前文普及过程呼应，"learn, think independently, and participate in society"概括读写带来的机会。

- [5] E：
    - **线索**：空前描述当代多种书写形式及人类记录与分享的持久需求，空后需收束全文。E的"From clay tablets to digital screens"呼应全文载体演变，"continues to connect people and preserve the ideas"是全文主题的升华收尾。
- **干扰项分析**：
    - **F. For instance, the Rosetta Stone helped scholars decode Egyptian hieroglyphics because it contained the same text in three different scripts.**：以For instance开头，为具体考古案例（罗塞塔石碑）。各空均为概括或过渡句；[2]易被误选因涉及埃及象形文字，但该空需总结各书写系统的共同目的，而非解码某一种文字的历史个案。